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DUBAI MALLATHON TURNS MALLS INTO FITNESS TRACKS

Thousands of residents and visitors are taking part in Dubai Mallathon 2026, a unique summer fitness initiative that transforms some of the emirate's largest shopping malls into indoor walking and running tracks. Running from June 15 to September 15, the event, being held at Dubai Mall, Mall of the Emirates, Mirdif City Centre, Dubai Festival City Mall, Deira City Centre and Dubai Hills Mall, encourages people of all ages to stay active in a safe, air-conditioned environment during the hottest months of the year.

Dubai's AI park design contest offers cash prizes

DUBAI
BY ASHFAQ AHMED
Managing Editor

Dubai has launched the world's first artificial intelligence-powered park design challenge, inviting architects, urban planners, students, researchers and technology innovators from around the world to redesign Al Safa 2 Park using AI-driven solutions.

Participants are expected to develop practical and innovative master plans that improve sus-



tainability, accessibility, social interaction, well-being and overall quality of life. Entries must also demonstrate how AI tools were used throughout the design process, including spatial planning, climate-responsive solutions, user experience analysis and performance optimisation.

The competition offers a total prize pool of Dh200,000, with Dh100,000 for first place, Dh65,000 for second and Dh35,000 for third. Applications are open until August 15, and can be submitted through <https://aipark.dm.gov.ae/ai-competition>.

UAE JOINS ARAB STATES IN CONDEMNING IRANIAN ATTACKS ON BAHRAIN, KUWAIT

Fresh attacks denounced amid renewed strain on fragile truce

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

The UAE joined Gulf countries in strongly condemning renewed Iranian attacks targeting Bahrain and Kuwait with missiles and drones, describing them as a blatant violation of the sovereignty of the two Gulf states and a threat to regional security.

In a statement, the UAE Ministry of Foreign Affairs said the attacks posed a threat to the security and stability of Bahrain and Kuwait. It reaffirmed the UAE's full solidarity with both countries and its support for all measures aimed at preserving their security and stability.

Fresh escalation

The condemnation came after a fresh escalation in the Gulf. Kuwait said its armed forces intercepted two hostile ballistic missiles in its airspace early yesterday, with no casualties or damage reported. Bahrain also said it had again been targeted by Iranian ballistic missiles and drones, describing the attack as part of a repeated pattern of aggression and urging the UN Security Council to act.

Saudi Arabia condemned, in the strongest terms, Iran's latest attacks on Kuwait and Bahrain, as well as attacks on "the security and freedom of navigation in the Strait of Hormuz."

Jasem Mohamed Albudaiwi, Secretary General of the Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC), also

TRUMP: IRAN 'WILL NO LONGER EXIST'

President Donald Trump again threatened Iran with annihilation yesterday following US strikes on Iranian military targets.

"United States aircraft just struck Iranian missile and drone storage locations, and coastal radar sites, for violating the Cease Fire Agreement, AGAIN!" Trump wrote on Truth Social. Trump accused Iran of breaching the ceasefire and warned there could come a point when the United States would no longer be able to remain restrained and "will be forced to militarily complete the job."

"If that happens, the Islamic Republic of Iran will no longer exist!" he wrote. The latest warning echoed earlier posts in which Trump used similarly stark language. In April, he warned that "a whole civilisation will die tonight" and raised the spectre of nuclear war. In May, he wrote: "For Iran, the Clock is Ticking, and they better get moving, FAST, or there won't be anything left of them."

—S. N. R.

condemned what he described as the "terrorist Iranian attacks" against Bahrain and Kuwait.

In a statement, he said the "treacherous attacks constitute a direct threat to the security, stability and safety of citizens and residents" of the two countries, adding that "the continuation of these Iranian attacks actively undermines ongoing regional and international efforts aimed at consolidating peace and security and resolving the crisis."

Dialogue, de-escalation

Qatar also strongly condemned the attacks, stressing "the necessity of sparing the region the consequences of these unjustified attacks, continuing on the path of dialogue and diplomacy, de-escalation, and building on the achievements realised within the framework of the memorandum of understanding, in a way that contributes to consolidating security

and stability at both the regional and international levels."

Jordan and Egypt likewise denounced the attacks.

'Flagrant violation'

Kuwait condemned what it called the "repeated heinous Iranian aggressions against the State of Kuwait," saying the latest missile attack at dawn represented "a flagrant violation of its sovereignty, a direct threat to its security and stability, and the safety of its citizens and residents."

Bahrain said Iran had once again targeted the kingdom with ballistic missiles and drones in "a dangerous escalation that reveals Tehran's actions are neither isolated nor incidental, but rather a deliberate policy and systematic pattern of repeated aggression against the kingdom's sovereignty and the security of its citizens and residents."

The renewed exchange of at-

tacks followed US strikes on multiple military targets in Iran, which Washington said were carried out in response to an earlier attack on a commercial vessel transiting the Strait of Hormuz. Iran and the United States have since accused each other of violating the fragile ceasefire that underpins efforts to end the conflict.

Iran warning

Speaking in Baghdad yesterday, Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi warned that any attempt to bypass shipping routes agreed under the memorandum of understanding with the United States would only worsen the crisis.

"Any attempt to adopt new or separate arrangements compared to what is underway by the Islamic Republic of Iran, will only lead to more complicated situations and delays in the reopening of the Strait of Hormuz, and will increase the tensions, as we witnessed in the past two nights," Araghchi said.

He urged all parties to "adhere to the memorandum of understanding and not to allow this MoU to deviate from its course," while calling for a new regional security framework involving Gulf countries, Iran and Iraq without outside interference.

Two days after a US-brokered agreement was signed between Israel, Lebanon and the US aimed at moving toward a broader peace deal, fighting continued in southern Lebanon, with fresh Israeli attacks reported yesterday.

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UAE sends \$10m in aid to Venezuela

President offers condolences as earthquake toll crosses 1,400

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan on Friday held a phone call with Delcy Rodríguez, Acting President of Venezuela, to convey his sincere condolences over the victims of the recent earthquake and wish a speedy recovery to those injured.

Sheikh Mohamed reaffirmed the UAE's solidarity with Venezuela and its people during this challenging time.

Rodríguez thanked Sheikh Mohamed for his sincere expressions of solidarity with the Venezuelan people and praised the UAE's swift humanitarian response in providing relief following the earthquake.

Earlier, Sheikh Mohamed directed the provision of \$10 million in urgent relief assistance to those affected by the

earthquake in Venezuela, as part of the UAE's humanitarian commitment to supporting people affected by natural disasters and crises around the world.

50,000 missing

Rescue crews raced Saturday to find survivors in the rubble of Venezuela's powerful twin earthquakes as the death toll reached 1,430, around 50 of them foreign nationals, with hopes dwindling 72 hours after the earth roared and rumbled.

Millions of people were feared to lack sanitation and other basic needs, as the first US aid flights landed in Caracas.

Tens of thousands of people were reported missing as collapsed buildings dotted cities in a country already enduring an economic crisis and political upheaval after US special forces captured authoritarian leader Nicolas Maduro in January.

UN aid chief Tom Fletcher on Friday told AFP the death toll could continue to soar, adding that more than 50,000 people were missing.

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WORLD CUP

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